

1 Corinthians 16:15-16

¹⁵ I beseech you, brethren, (ye know the house of Stephanas, that it is the firstfruits of Achaia, and **that they have addicted**^{G5021} themselves to the ministry of the saints,)

¹⁶ That ye submit yourselves unto such, and to every one that helpeth with *us*, and laboureth.

What is the first thought that comes to mind when you read the word “addicted”?

Unless you’ve studied this word carefully, which is one among the 4,002 unique words that appear only once in the Bible, you will likely get the meaning wrong. The context gives us a clue in the phrase “*that ye submit yourselves unto such*” but there is more understanding to be gleaned if we are willing to work at it. To do that, we will look at every occurrence of the same Strong’s number that corresponds to “that they have addicted” which is G5021.

G5021 (appears 8 times in 8 verses)

Mat 28:16 Then the eleven disciples went away into Galilee, into a mountain where Jesus **had appointed** them.

Luk 7:8 For I also am a man **set** under authority, having under me soldiers, and I say unto one, Go, and he goeth; and to another, Come, and he cometh; and to my servant, Do this, and he doeth it.

Act 13:48 And when the Gentiles heard this, they were glad, and glorified the word of the Lord: and as many as were **ordained** to eternal life believed.

Act 15:2 When therefore Paul and Barnabas had no small dissension and disputation with them, **they determined** that Paul and Barnabas, and certain other of them, should go up to Jerusalem unto the apostles and elders about this question.

Act 22:10 And I said, What shall I do, Lord? And the Lord said unto me, Arise, and go into Damascus; and there it shall be told thee of all things which **are appointed** for thee to do.

Act 28:23 And **when they had appointed** him a day, there came many to him into his lodging; to whom he expounded and testified the kingdom of God, persuading them concerning Jesus, both out of the law of Moses, and out of the prophets, from morning till evening.

Rom 13:1 Let every soul be subject unto the higher powers. For there is no power but of God: the powers that be are **ordained** of God.

Summary of G5021

had appointed, set, ordained (x2), they determined, are appointed, when they had appointed, addicted

The Corinthians are being urgently implored to submit themselves to who? The house of Stephanos and every one that helpeth with us, and laboureth [to the ministry of the saints]. Why? Because they have determined that they have been set/ordained/appointed a position alongside Paul (**2Cor 10:8**) for the work of ministering to the saints (that is, serving and edifying the body of Christ). The fact that those servants were the first fruits in that region is telling in and of itself but that’s a separate Bible study. Ministers of the body of Christ are held in high regard (**Mat 20:25-28**) and the Corinthians are entreated to submit themselves to them.

Man has within him the sinful tendency to want to rule over everyone else and there doesn't seem to be a limit to what lengths they will go to accomplish this evil (eg. [Judges 9:1-5](#)). Men have strove with each other since Cain & Abel in vain for glory that could never satisfy or be blessed.

God's word teaches us that we should not only submit ourselves to each other but also to those who are "set" above us in positions of authority, and their ordinances.

[1 Peter 5:5](#)

Likewise, ye younger, submit yourselves unto the elder. Yea, **all of you be subject one to another**, and be clothed with humility: for God resisteth the proud, and giveth grace to the humble.

[1 Peter 2:13-19](#)

- ¹³ **Submit yourselves to every ordinance of man** for the Lord's sake: whether it be **to the king**, as supreme;
- ¹⁴ Or **unto governors**, as **unto them that are sent by him** for the punishment of evildoers, and for the praise of them that do well.
- ¹⁵ **For so is the will of God**, that with well doing ye may put to silence the ignorance of foolish men:
- ¹⁶ As free, and not using *your* liberty for a cloke of maliciousness, but **as the servants of God**.
- ¹⁷ Honour all *men*. Love the brotherhood. Fear God. Honour the king.
- ¹⁸ Servants, **be subject to your masters** with all fear; **not only to the good and gentle, but also to the froward**.
- ¹⁹ For this *is* thankworthy, if a man for conscience toward God endure grief, suffering wrongfully.

[Romans 13:1-4](#)

- ¹ Let every soul be subject unto the higher powers. For there is no power but of God: **the powers that be are ordained of God**.
- ² Whosoever therefore resisteth the power, resisteth the ordinance of God: and they that resist shall receive to themselves damnation.
- ³ For rulers are not a terror to good works, but to the evil. Wilt thou then not be afraid of the power? do that which is good, and thou shalt have praise of the same:
- ⁴ **For he is the minister of God to thee for good**. But if thou do that which is evil, be afraid; for he beareth not the sword in vain: for **he is the minister of God**, a revenger to *execute* wrath upon him that doeth evil.

In doing so, as we have been commanded, we follow in the footsteps of the author and finisher of our faith by taking on the form of a servant ([Mat 20:26-28](#), [Mar 10:43-45](#)).